

Adobe Customer Journey Analytics (CJA)

Setup Flow & Interview Prep Guide

Functional / Product Interview Ready

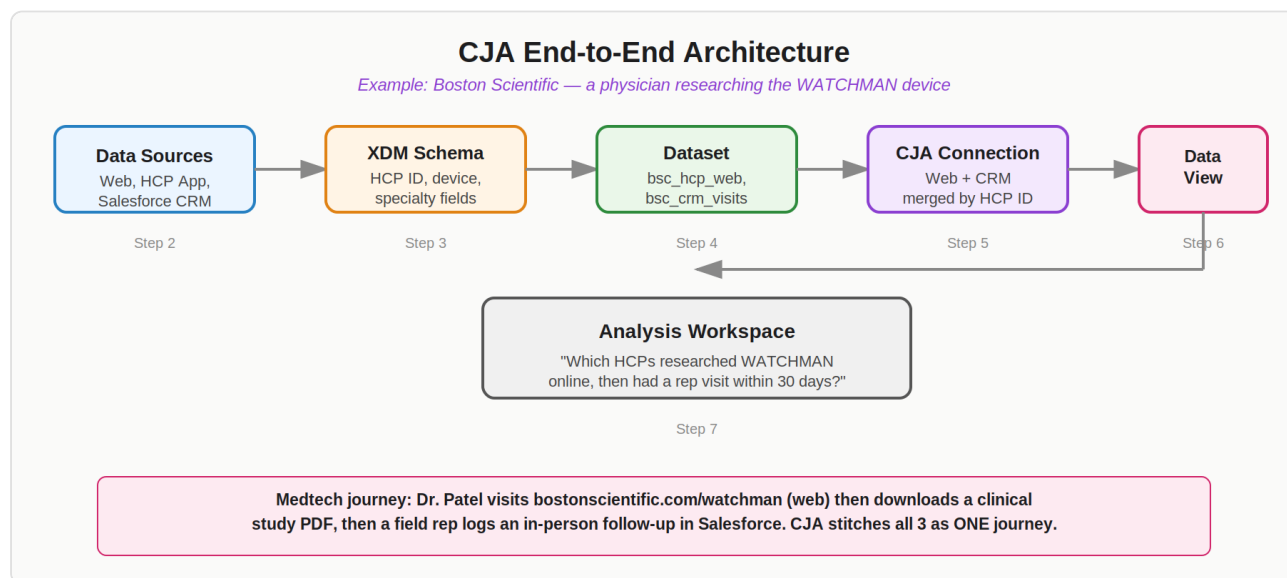
Covers: end-to-end setup flow, key terminology, GA vs Adobe Analytics vs CJA mapping, common interview Q&A, and hands-on demo URLs

Running example throughout this guide:

Boston Scientific (medtech) — tracking a cardiologist's journey researching the WATCHMAN device across web, HCP mobile app, and Salesforce CRM.

The Big Picture First

Before diving into steps, understand this: CJA doesn't collect data itself. It's a **reporting and stitching layer** that sits on top of the Adobe Experience Platform (AEP). Your data comes from other sources (web, app, CRM, call center) into AEP, gets structured, and CJA lets you analyze it all together as unified customer journeys.



Interview soundbite: "CJA's core value is combining multiple data sources into one person-centric view, instead of siloed reports per channel like GA or Adobe Analytics gave you."

Want to click through this yourself?

Adobe doesn't offer a fully open public CJA demo, but you can get hands-on two ways:

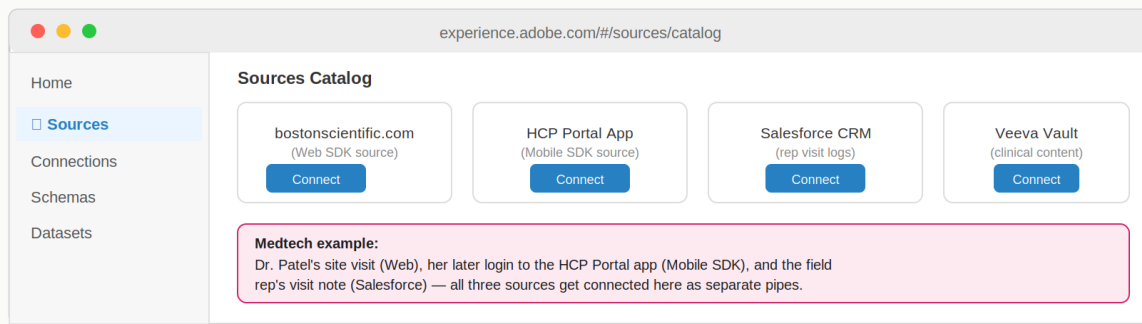
1. **Adobe Experience League tutorials** — free step-by-step labs using Adobe's own "Luma" sample brand data: experienceleague.adobe.com/en/docs/analytics-platform/using/cja-overview
2. **Trial sandbox** — if your org has any Experience Platform license, System/Product Admins can spin up a free Development sandbox (Settings → Sandboxes → Create Sandbox) to practice every step below risk-free.

Step-by-Step Setup Flow

1 Connect Data Sources

This is where you tell Adobe Experience Platform where your data actually lives.

Step 1 — Connect Data Sources



Demo URL: <https://experience.adobe.com/#!/@yourorgname/sname:prod/platform/source/catalog>

How to do it:

1. Go to Experience Platform → left nav → **Sources**
2. Open the **Catalog** tab — pick your source (Adobe Analytics, CRM, cloud storage, CSV, etc.)
3. Click **Connect**, authenticate, and configure how often data should sync

<https://experience.adobe.com/#!/@yourorgname/sname:prod/platform/source/catalog>

Boston Scientific example: Three sources get connected here — the bostonscientific.com web property (Web SDK), the HCP Portal mobile app (Mobile SDK), and Salesforce (rep visit logs). Each becomes its own "Source Connection" pipe.

Simple term: A "Source Connection" is just a pipe — it moves raw data from outside into Adobe's world.

2 Build the XDM Schema

The schema is the blueprint that defines what fields exist and how they're structured — this replaces the old "prop vs eVar" decision entirely.

Step 2 — Build the XDM Schema

The screenshot shows the Adobe Experience Platform Schema Builder interface. The browser address bar displays `experience.adobe.com/#!/schema/browse`. The interface is divided into three main sections:

- BSC HCP Engagement Schema:** This section shows two classes. The first class, `XDM Experience Event`, has three field groups: `+ Web field group` (green), `+ Content Download field` (green), and `+ Custom: deviceInterest` (orange). The second class, `XDM Individual Profile`, has one field group: `+ HCP Profile field group` (purple).
- Field Details:** This section shows details for two fields. The first field is `deviceInterest` with a value of `"WATCHMAN"` and a scope of `Event-level (≈ old prop)`. The second field is `hcpSpecialty` with a value of `"Electrophysiology"` and a scope of `Profile-level (≈ old eVar)`.
- Identity Field:** This section shows details for the `hcpNPINumber` field, which is identified as the `Identity Field`. It has a value of `"National Provider ID"` and a description: `This is what links Dr. Patel's web visit + app login + CRM record into ONE physician journey.` Below this description is a button labeled `Set as Identity →`.

Demo URL: <https://experience.adobe.com/#!/@yourorgname/sname:prod/platform/schema/browse>
Use the free Adobe Experience Platform Sandbox / Skillbuilder trial to practice schema building hands-on.

How to do it:

1. Go to **Schemas** → **Create Schema**
2. Choose a base class: **XDM Experience Event** (for things that happened) or **XDM Individual Profile** (for who a person is)
3. Add field groups (standard or custom) to define your fields
4. Mark one field (e.g., email or ECID) as the **Identity** — this is what stitches a person's journey together

<https://experience.adobe.com/#!/@yourorgname/sname:prod/platform/schema/browse>

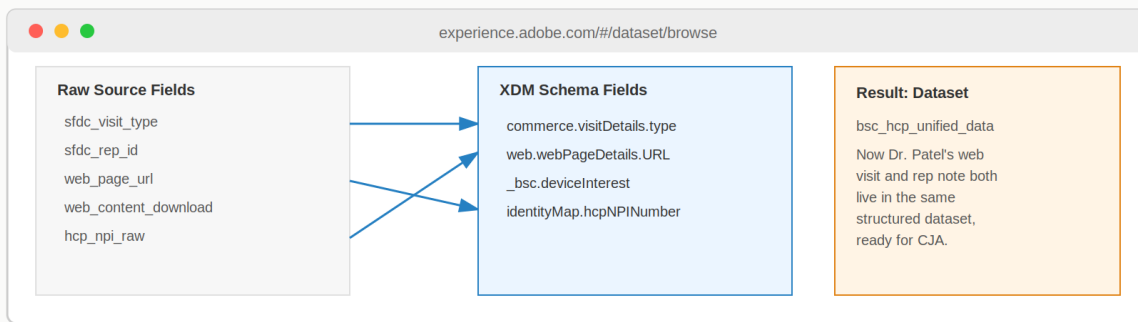
Boston Scientific example: Custom field `deviceInterest` captures "WATCHMAN" at the event level (like an old prop). `hcpSpecialty` lives on the Profile class (like an old eVar). The Identity field is `hcpNPINumber` — the physician's National Provider ID — so every touchpoint from that doctor stitches into one journey.

Simple term: Event-level fields ≈ old "props." Profile-level / identity-stitched fields ≈ old "eVars," but done properly via a real customer identity instead of an expiration timer.

3 Create Dataset & Map Fields

Now your raw incoming data needs to be translated into the schema's language.

Step 3 — Create Dataset & Map Fields



Demo URL: <https://experience.adobe.com/#!/@yourorgname/sname:prod/platform/dataset/browse>
Field mapping UI: appears automatically during Source Connection setup (Step 1) as a mapping step.

How to do it:

1. When setting up a source connection, choose "map to a schema" (or go to **Datasets** → **Create Dataset**)
2. Select the target XDM schema you built in Step 2
3. Map each raw source field (e.g., *ga_page_path*) to its matching schema field (e.g., *web.webPageDetails.name*)
4. Validate and activate the mapping — this creates a live Dataset

<https://experience.adobe.com/#!/@yourorgname/sname:prod/platform/dataset/browse>

Boston Scientific example: Raw Salesforce field *sfdc_visit_type* maps to *commerce.visitDetails.type*; raw web field *web_content_download* maps to *_bsc.deviceInterest*. The result is one clean dataset, *bsc_hcp_unified_data*, where Dr. Patel's web activity and the rep's CRM note speak the same schema language.

Simple term: Mapping = translating your GA/CRM field names into Adobe's schema language so everything speaks the same format.

4 Create a CJA Connection

This is the CJA-specific step where multiple datasets get merged into one unified view.

Step 4 — Create a CJA Connection

experience.adobe.com/#!/cja/connections

Connection Name:

Select Datasets: ☐ ☐ ☐

Person ID field:

[Save & Enable Connection](#)

Demo URL: <https://experience.adobe.com/#!/@yourorgname/sname:prod/cja/connections>
Result: Dr. Patel's web visit, app login, and rep note now count as ONE HCP's journey, not 3 separate records.

How to do it:

1. In CJA (not core AEP), go to **Connections** → **Create Connection**
2. Name it, then select all the Datasets you want combined (e.g., Web + App + CRM)
3. Confirm the Person ID / Identity field CJA should stitch on
4. Save — this becomes your unified dataset foundation for reporting

<https://experience.adobe.com/#!/@yourorgname/sname:prod/cja/connections>

Boston Scientific example: "BSC HCP Omnichannel Connection" merges *bsc_hcp_web*, *bsc_hcp_app*, and *bsc_crm_visits*, all stitched on *hcpNPINumber*. From here on, Dr. Patel's activity across all three channels counts as one HCP journey, not three disconnected records.

Simple term: The Connection is the "glue" step — it's what makes CJA different from plain Adobe Analytics, since it merges channels instead of reporting them separately.

5 Build a Data View

A Data View is a curated menu of exactly which fields are allowed to show up in reporting.

Step 5 — Build a Data View

experience.adobe.com/#/cja/dataviews

Dimensions (toggle ON)

- ☒ Device Interest (WATCHMAN, etc.)
- ☒ HCP Specialty
- ☒ Touchpoint Channel
- ☐ Internal Rep Notes (off)
- ☒ Region

Metrics (toggle ON)

- ☒ HCP Web Sessions
- ☒ Clinical Content Downloads
- ☒ Rep Visits Logged
- ☒ Days: Web Visit → Rep Follow-up

Demo URL: <https://experience.adobe.com/#/@yourorgname/sname:prod/cja/dataviews>

Field-rep sales notes stay OFF for a marketing analyst's Data View — governance keeps sensitive data scoped.

How to do it:

1. Go to **Data Views** → **Create Data View**, and select your Connection from Step 4
2. Toggle ON the dimensions (descriptive fields) and metrics (numbers) you want available to analysts
3. Set default settings — currency, time zone, session timeout definitions
4. Save and publish the Data View

<https://experience.adobe.com/#/@yourorgname/sname:prod/cja/dataviews>

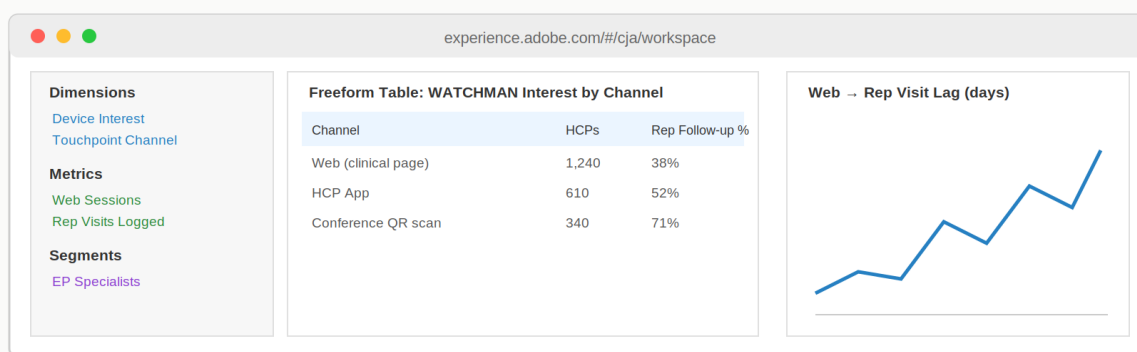
Boston Scientific example: Marketing analysts get Device Interest, HCP Specialty, and Touchpoint Channel — but "Internal Rep Notes" (sensitive Salesforce free-text) stays toggled OFF. This is how a Data View enforces data governance between commercial and marketing teams.

Simple term: Not every field needs to be report-ready — the Data View keeps Workspace clean by only exposing what's actually useful.

6 Report in Analysis Workspace

This is where the actual analysis happens — building tables, visualizations, and dashboards.

Step 6 — Report in Analysis Workspace



Demo URL: <https://experience.adobe.com/#!/@yourorgname/sname:prod/cja/workspace/new>
This answers: "Does digital HCP engagement actually drive faster field-rep follow-up?"

How to do it:

1. Go to **Analysis Workspace** → **Create New Project**
2. Select your Data View from Step 5
3. Drag dimensions and metrics onto a Freeform Table or visualization
4. Add segments/filters as needed, then save or share the project as a dashboard

<https://experience.adobe.com/#!/@yourorgname/sname:prod/cja/workspace/new>

Boston Scientific example: A freeform table breaks down WATCHMAN interest by channel (Web, HCP App, Conference QR) against "% resulting in a rep follow-up." This answers a real commercial question: does digital HCP engagement actually drive faster field-rep action?

Simple term: This is the "GA reporting screen" equivalent — except now it's powered by every channel you connected, not just web.

Terminology Cheat Sheet

Adobe Analytics / GA Term	CJA Equivalent	Boston Scientific Example
Prop (Traffic Variable)	Event-scoped XDM field	<i>deviceInterest</i> = "WATCHMAN" on a single page view
eVar (Conversion Variable)	Profile-scoped field / Identity stitching	<i>hcpSpecialty</i> = "Electrophysiology" persists on Dr. Patel's profile
Event / Metric	Metric field in schema	"Clinical Content Downloads" count
Report Suite	Data View + Connection	"BSC HCP Omnichannel" Connection + Data View
GA4 Custom Dimension	XDM Field (event or profile scoped)	"Touchpoint Channel" (Web / App / Conference)
Segments	Segments (same concept)	"EP Specialists" segment
N/A (new in CJA)	Identity Stitching	<i>hcpNPINumber</i> links Dr. Patel's web + app + CRM activity

Common Functional Interview Questions

Q: What's the main difference between Adobe Analytics and CJA?

A: Adobe Analytics reports on one data source (typically web/app) with a fixed prop/eVar model. CJA combines multiple data sources (web, app, CRM, offline, call center) into a single person-centric view using XDM schemas and identity stitching — no fixed variable limits. For a medtech company like Boston Scientific, that means seeing one HCP's full journey — web research, app usage, and field-rep visits — instead of three disconnected reports.

Q: Walk me through the CJA setup flow.

A: Connect data sources → build an XDM schema → map data into a Dataset → create a CJA Connection joining datasets → build a Data View to curate reportable fields → analyze in Workspace. In our example: connect Web + HCP App + Salesforce → schema with an NPI-based Identity → unified HCP dataset → BSC Connection → HCP-facing Data View → Workspace report on device interest vs. rep follow-up.

Q: How does CJA handle cross-device / cross-channel identity?

A: Through Identity Stitching — one field in the schema (email, login ID, ECID, or in our example an NPI number) is marked as the Identity, and Adobe uses it to link all events for that person into a single journey, regardless of device or channel.

Q: What would you migrate first when moving from GA to CJA?

A: Start with mapping GA's key events/conversions to XDM fields, run both tools in parallel to validate parity, then migrate segments/custom dimensions, and only sunset GA after a validated cutover period.

Q: What's a Data View and why does it matter?

A: It's a curated, report-ready layer sitting on top of a Connection — it controls exactly which fields analysts can see and use. In a regulated industry like medtech, this also enforces governance — e.g., keeping sensitive Salesforce rep notes hidden from a marketing analyst's Data View while still exposing engagement metrics.

Q: Why would identity resolution be especially important for a medtech company?

A: HCPs interact across many disconnected systems — public website, gated HCP portals, conference lead scans, and CRM visit logs. Without a reliable identity (like an NPI number), each touchpoint looks like a different anonymous visitor, making it impossible to measure whether digital engagement actually influences field activity or prescribing behavior.

Guide built for interview preparation — flow diagrams are simplified representations of the Adobe Experience Platform / CJA UI for study purposes.